PFI Submittal Package

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Product overview

Pocket Form Isolator® (PFI®) is a stay-in-place HDPE form that creates column isolation pockets in slab-on-grade concrete. It is made in the USA by Forrester Manufacturing Co. in Buford, Georgia, and applies to every PFI product, including the Arcline round series.

Isolation pockets sit at the base of columns that bear on individual footings. They do four jobs:

- **Protect the column base.** They keep moisture away from anchor bolts, grout bed, base plate and the lower column.
- **End slab joints.** They give construction and control joints a clean terminus.
- **Add dead load.** A concrete-filled pocket weighs more than soil or gravel, which engineers can count against wind uplift.
- **Leave an inspection portal.** The pocket can be opened later if problems come up.

When engineers specify isolation pockets, their drawings show plan and section views of what the flatwork contractor must build. PFI delivers that pocket the same way every time, with no form to strip.

Key benefits

PFI stays in place, so every problem that comes from stripping temporary forms goes away.

Benefit	What it means on the job
No form removal	No stripping, no damaged slab edges, no nail-filled lumber or foam left on site.
Pour slab and pocket together	Slab and infill can be cast at the same time, so the concrete matches in color and finish.
No expansion joint material	PFI separates the two concrete volumes on its own, even when both are cast together.

Benefit	What it means on the job
Zip-Strip® compatible	Attach a Zip-Strip "Void-Cap" or similar along the top edge and set it at finish floor elevation for a clean caulk joint.
Penetrations stay sealed	Drill for conduit, plumbing or roof drains with ordinary woodworking tools. The form never comes out, so the penetration is never disturbed.
No carpenter needed	Simple parts go together with standard hand tools.
Schedule flexibility	Form size does not depend on the pour sequence, unlike temporary forming and bracing.
Durable HDPE	Will not rust, rot, swell, buckle, absorb water, grow mold or stain adjacent concrete; termites ignore it.
Recycled material	Made from recycled HDPE, replacing lumber and throwaway foam.
Safer site	Little or no field cutting, drilling makes no sparks, fumes or harmful dust, and there is no removal step.

Bracing is rarely needed. When it is, PFI provides bracing, casting and backfill recommendations with the order.



Applications

PFI's main use is column isolation pockets. The same form also handles piers and under-slab pull boxes.

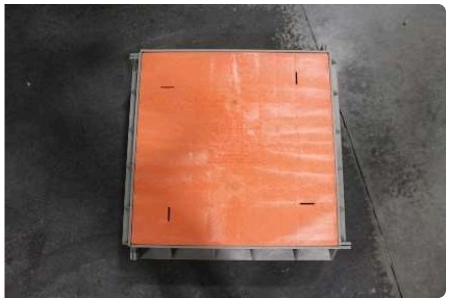
- **Column isolation pockets.** Square, two-sided, corner and Arcline round shapes at the base of columns on spread footings.
- **Integral pier forms.** For pre-engineered steel buildings with piers above the footings: set the forms, backfill around them, place the dowels, then cast slab and piers together.
- **Refrigeration pull boxes.** Grocery and food-service slabs route refrigeration lines under the floor. Raceway holes are drilled through the PFI walls at our plant or in the field.

Orange safety lids

Orange safety lids are available for 24″ square PFI and 32″ diameter Arcline. They are integrally colored for high visibility and sit flush on a ledge molded into the top edge of every screed-edge part. Posted load limit: 150 PSF.



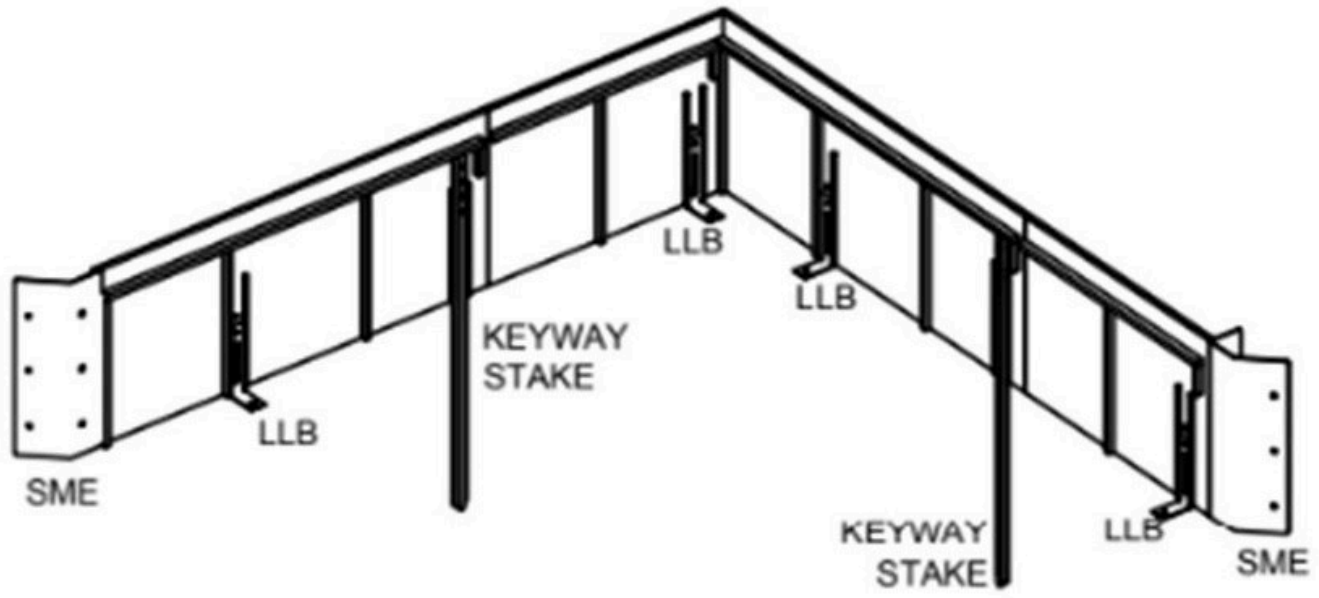




Anchorage and hardware

Every order ships with its assembly bolts and anchorage hardware, a hardware sheet listing what goes on each part, and a field-assembly instruction sheet. How it anchors depends on what it sits on or against.

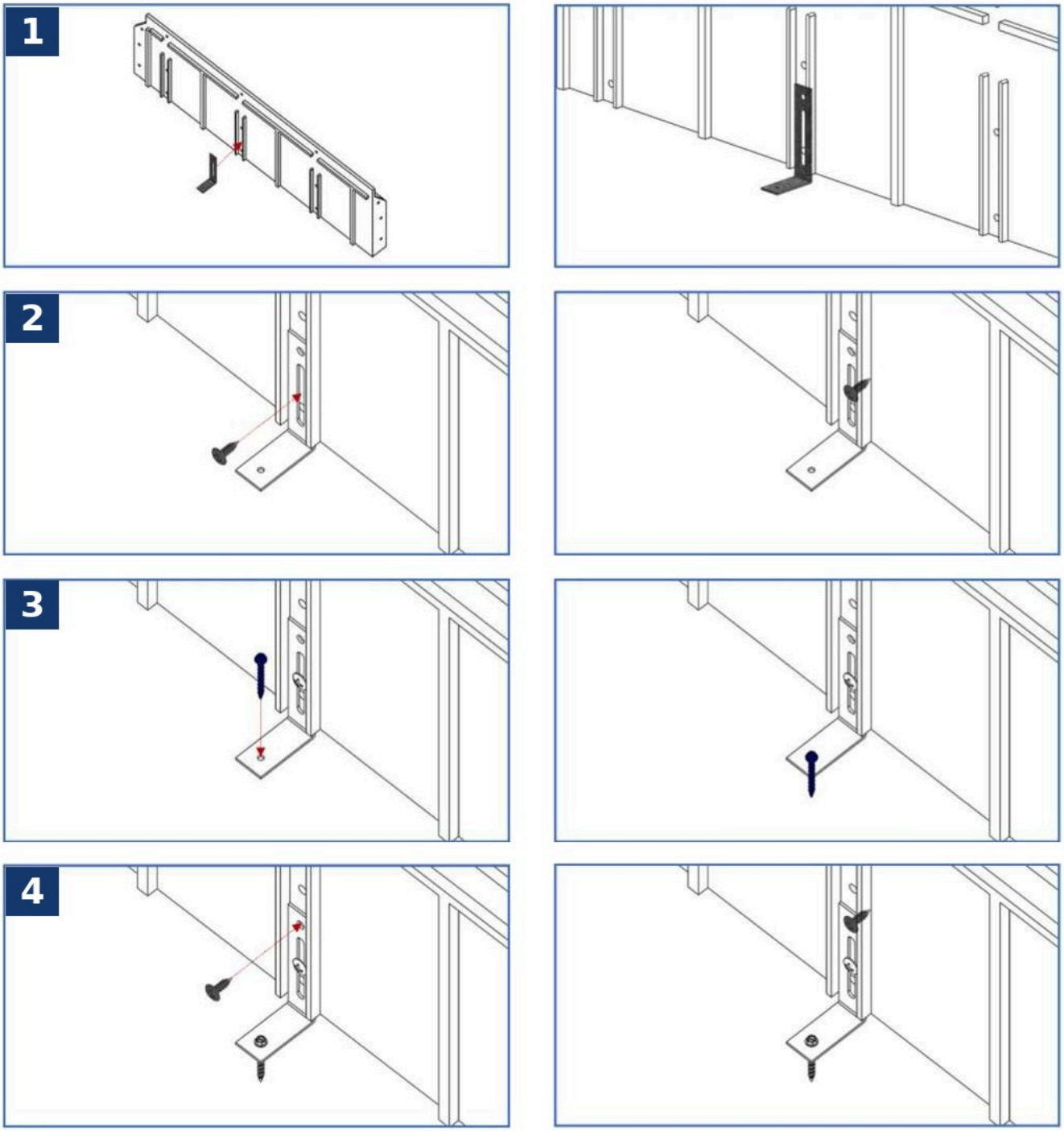
Condition	Hardware	Supplied by
PFI on a footing	Locking Lift Brackets (LLBs): 1″ wide L-brackets with 2-1/2″ of sliding adjustment, plus two #14-10 x 3/4″ self-tapping screws and one Tapcon for each LLB	Forrester
PFI against a wall or form at the slab edge	Sheet Metal Extensions (SMEs): bent brackets with holes for bolts, nails or Tapcons, plus a Tapcon for each SME	Forrester
Base plate on a pier or pedestal	Galvanized steel screed keyway stakes, set tight to the smooth inside face of the PFI, plus self-threading wood screws through each stake into the PFI	Contractor



Anchoring to footings (LLB installation)

The number of LLBs per part is listed on the hardware sheet shipped with your order.

1. **Align.** Set the LLB in its guide channel, if the part has one, or along a vertical rib.
2. **Index.** Let the LLB extend 1/4″ to 1/2″ below the bottom edge of the PFI. Drive a #14-10 x 3/4″ self-tapping screw into the LLB's milled slot until hand tight.
3. **Fasten to the footing.** Drive a Tapcon through the foot of the LLB into the footing.
4. **Level and lock.** Back the first screw off a quarter turn if needed and level the PFI to grade. Lock it with a second #14-10 x 3/4″ screw, then tighten all screws to **90 in-lb (7.5 ft-lb)**.



The sliding adjustment takes up uneven footing tops, which are common.

Anchoring at slab edges (SME installation)

Partial pockets at the slab perimeter fasten to the edge form with SMEs at both ends.

- **Permanent edge** (CMU, tilt-up, cast-in-place or precast wall): attach SMEs with permanent fasteners driven toward the building exterior.

- **Temporary edge form**: attach SMEs with removable fasteners driven toward the building interior.
- **Form that can't take a fastener**: hold the PFI with C-clamps until enough slab concrete is placed to hold it in position.



Request a quote

Send plans or a column schedule and we'll quote the job.

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